

Chinese Automotive OEMs: Overseas Plants

Source notes behind the Transitions Lab piece *China ships the factory, not just the car*. Shared verbatim so readers can see the underlying research.

Existing Factories of Chinese automotive companies abroad:

BYD:

Rayong, Thailand: production began in July 2024, with a designated annual capacity of 150,000 vehicles. Actual use is 30 per cent of designated capacity.

Camaçari, Brazil (a former Ford site): the Camaçari complex began assembling vehicles in July 2025. The annual capacity of operations is 150,000 electric and hybrid cars a year, which can be scaled up to double the amount. It is BYD's largest investment outside of Asia.

Szeged, Hungary: trial for passenger vehicle production started in January 2026, with full series production scheduled for Q2 2026 and an eventual capacity of about 200,000 vehicles a year. The company's first "Made in Europe" production.

Subang, Indonesia: BYD opened a second regional plant on September 3 with a capacity of 150,000 vehicles a year.

Great Wall Motor (GWM):

Tula, Russia: 500 million dollar investment with an annual capacity of 150,000 vehicles, producing since 2019.

Rayong, Thailand: annual capacity of 80,000 vehicles opened in June 2021 on a former GM site.

Iracemápolis, Brazil: converted from a Daimler plant acquired in 2021, with an annual capacity of 50,000 vehicles. Production started in August 2025.

Chery:

Barcelona, Spain (Ebro joint venture, former Nissan plant): Ebro holds 60% and Chery 40%. The partners have invested more than 150 million Euro and the plant could produce up to 200,000 vehicles annually.

Geely (through Volvo Cars):

Volvo is 78.7% owned by Geely Holding and runs plants in Torslanda, Sweden and Ghent, Belgium. The plant in Ridgeville, South Carolina (US) has installed capacity of 150,000 vehicles a year.

Planned investments of Chinese automotive companies abroad:

BYD:

Manisa, Turkey: construction of a plant with an investment of 1 billion dollar and annual capacity of 150,000 vehicles is on hold.

SAIC (MG):

Galicia, Spain: first factory in Europe, with a 200 million Euro investment, annual capacity of 120,000 vehicles. Start of operation in 2028.

Chery:

Lembah Beringin, Malaysia: industrial park to finish in 2027.

Barcelona, Spain: Chery wants to add capacity at its Barcelona joint venture.

Geely:

São José dos Pinhais, Brazil (Renault plant): Geely bought a 26,4% stake in Renault Brasil. The partners announced a joint investment of 3.8 billion R (real) at the Ayrton Senna complex to produce new car models.

Market shares of Chinese automotive companies across continents:

Europe: as of March 2026, Chinese automotive companies are set to cross the 4% market share barrier in Europe.

US: no percentages found in reports. Chinese manufacturers are largely shut out by high tariffs on Chinese imports.

South America (Brazil): the market share for electrified vehicles climbed to 25.2%.

Southeast Asia: Chinese OEMs reached about 15.7% of the ASEAN-6 market in H1 2026.